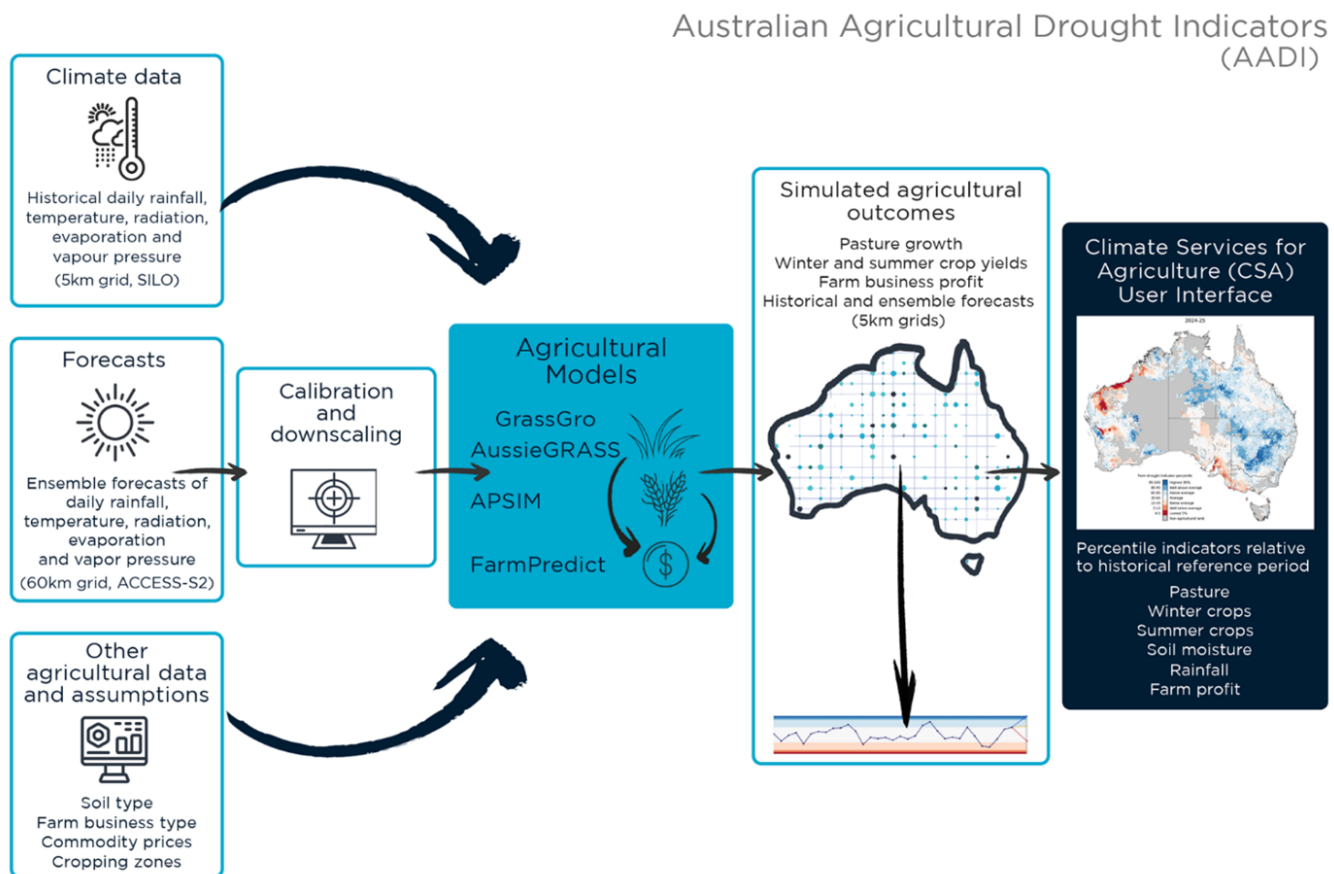


The Australian Agricultural Drought Indicators (AADI) tool, jointly developed by CSIRO and ABARES, is a flagship national resource supporting the Australian Government's efforts to improve drought preparedness and response. Using a newly developed set of drought indicators, AADI provides data-driven insights to improve the Government's drought monitoring and forecasting capability.

AADI is designed to take historical and forecast climate data as inputs to a number of economic and biophysical agricultural simulation models, to provide short-term forecasts for a range of agricultural outcomes including:

- Crop yields – provides an indication of the effect of forecast weather conditions on winter crop and summer crop yields
- Pasture growth – simulated pasture growth provides an indication of the effects of weather conditions on the amount of new grass available for livestock.
- Farm profit – provides an indication of the overall effects of forecast weather conditions and prices on annual farm business profits.



Publications

[The Australian Agricultural Drought Indicators: Progress report](#)

Published: 23 April 2024

The Australian Agricultural Drought Indicators (AADI) project, formerly known as the [Drought Early Warning System](#) (DEWS), was established in April 2022 by the Commonwealth Department of

Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry (DAFF). The project was established in response to reviews of the 2018–2019 and 2019–2020 drought events, which identified a need to develop new drought indicators and generally improve the Australian government’s drought monitoring and forecasting capability (see ABARES 2022).

Monitoring agricultural and economic drought: the Australian Agricultural Drought Indicators

Published: 17 September 2025

Drought events can have significant agricultural and economic impacts, and in many parts of the world their intensity appears to be increasing with climate change. However, drought measurement remains a highly contested space, with a multitude of indicators across both research and operational settings. This article presents a new drought monitoring and forecasting system: the Australian Agricultural Drought Indicators (AADI).

Forecasting agricultural drought: the Australian Agricultural Drought Indicators

Published: 21 October 2025

Drought is a recurrent and significant driver of stress on agricultural enterprises in Australia. AADI (Australian Agricultural Drought Indicators) was recently developed to monitor and forecast drought for upcoming seasons using biophysical and agro-economic models, including crop yields, pasture growth and farm profit. Here, we evaluate the skill of drought indicator forecasts driven by the ACCESS-S2 dynamical global climate model over a hindcast period from 1990–2018.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/abares/research-topics/climate/aadi>